StarTribune Connect

WITH SUPPORT FROM

MINNESOTA PUBLIC RADIO®

We can't wait to partner with our 2024 RECIPIENTS.

Congratulations to our five recipients who will each receive $50,000 in marketing and advertising services to help their businesses grow, and thrive, in 2024.

Creatively Focused

We are an educator-driven technology company with a vision to empower educators with the time and resources they need for a fulfilling lifelong career. Our mission is to support special education teams with a one-stop resource that automates workflows, and enhances training, education, and professional development. What sets us apart is our human-centered SaaS platform, axis3, which combines workflow automation with personalized services and a curated resource library.

creativelyfocused.net

CREATIVELY FOCUSED

Jayded AF Cocktails

Within the Liquor industry there exists a market where recurring trends tend to separate young women from those who are more mature. Jayded AF tries to bridge this gap by recognizing their consumers as indeed their own individual brands. We aim to be the answer for consumers seeking an external representation of their own identity. British born of Nigerian descent, founder and CEO Alexa Jayde Fitzpatrick always knew her love of the eclectic and works to ensure her gin-inspired creations represent you in the best way. Starting with your cocktail of choice.

Jaydedaf.com

JAYDED AF

The Mali Center

The Mali Center mission is to return economic prosperity to Rondo and surrounding neighborhood communities. Our vision is to provide the model to build generational health and wealth with Black, Indigenous and People of Color (BIPOC) and women-owned businesses as the foundation. Our health and wellness business hub embraces diversity in an inclusive environment while providing equitable access and opportunity to small, BIPOC and women-owned businesses and nonprofits that prioritize underserved youth and communities of color.

MALI CENTER
Culture - Community - Connected

Reviving Roots Therapy & Wellness

Founded in August 2019 by Marlee James, MA, LPCC, Reviving Roots Therapy & Wellness started as a solo mental health practice. Recognizing the scarcity of mental health providers representing the Black community, we expanded our services to offer Black-centered holistic mental health and wellness by offering yoga and fitness classes, culturally curated wellness workshops, co-working space, mental health therapy, and massage therapy.

reviving-roots.com

Reviving Roots

Girls Dream Code

We are a nonprofit organization aiming to empower young girls of color, ages 10-24, to pursue an interest in technology by providing free tech and computer science programs. Our mission is to promote opportunities in technology, learn tech skills, decrease the gender and diversity gap in tech, increase inclusivity, and create a safe space for young girls to feel comfortable and excel in all that they do. Girls Dream Code was founded in 2020 by Victoria Kyereme, a software engineer, who was determined to do her part to increase the representation of women of color in tech.

girlsdreamcode.org

Girls Dream Code
Aspire To Be Great and Innovate!

The Star Tribune Connect program was created to **serve all of Minnesota — all day, every day —** by empowering the **future growth of minority and underrepresented business owners** through marketing collaboration and advertising assistance. Each recipient **exemplifies organizations that strive to uplift and make a difference in their communities**. We look forward, along with our partner MPR, to lending our support and helping all recipients grow and build their businesses in the year ahead.

These companies also entered our 2024 program and deserve your business as essential members.

ShelettaMakesMeLaugh.com
2MP Music LLC
Webb Tech Consulting
Wholesome Management
Lip Esteem LLC
Hidden Riches
SynchroLang
Strive Bookstore
Junita's Jar
Silk Road Wellness
Route 1 LLC
POSTPAL
Crayon Kelly LLC
Omi Live Inc
TradeOut
Nosh Posh
Lab Team Assistants
Culture Booster
Golf Evil LLC

5152363/3/24